

The black soil of western India is made up of lava; hence it is also known as Lava soil. The Malwa Plateau comes under this black soil region of the Deccan trap.

14. The predominant soil of Malwa Plateau is

- (a) Black soil
- (b) Alluvial soil
- (c) Red soil
- (d) Laterite

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

15. Which soil needs little irrigation as it retains soil water?

- (a) Red
- (b) Black
- (c) Laterite
- (d) Alluvial

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (b)

The black soil has a high moisture retention level. Remarkably "selfploughed" by loosened particles fallen from the ground into the cracks, the soil retains moisture. The black soil needs little irrigation as it retains soil water. Hence, option (b) is correct.

16. Where is black soil found in Jharkhand?

- (a) Damodar valley region
- (b) Subarnrekha river valley region
- (c) Rajmahal hill region
- (d) Palamu region

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (c)

According to the National Institute of Disaster Management (NIDM) report, black soil in Jharkhand is found in Rajmahal area.

17. Which of the following statements is NOT correct?

- (a) Black soil is locally called 'regur'
- (b) According to Krabs, the regur soil is essentially a mature soil
- (c) Black soils are highly retentive to moisture
- (d) Black soil is found in the Himalayan region

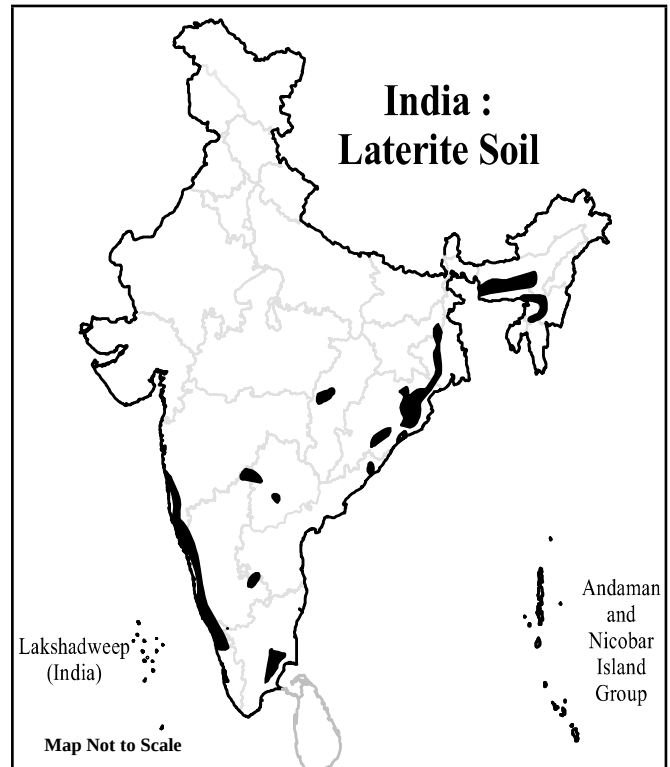
U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (d)

The Black soil is locally called regur, which is good for growing cotton. It is found mainly in the states of Maharashtra, Gujarat, Karnataka and Madhya Pradesh. Due to its high clay content and high iron content, the regur soil responds well to irrigation and retains moisture.

ii. Laterite Soil

*F.Buchanan- Hamilton carried out research on Laterite soil for the first time in 1807. Its name has been derived from the Latin word 'Later' which means 'brick'. *These soils are as soft as butter when wet but become harder like bricks when dry.



*The laterite soil is formed under conditions of high temperature and **heavy rainfall** with alternate wet and dry periods, which leads to the **leaching** of soil, leaving only oxides of iron and aluminium. The humus content of the soil is removed quickly by bacteria that thrive well in high temperatures. *These soils are poor in **Organic Matter, Nitrogen, Phosphate, and Calcium** while **Iron Oxide, Aluminium Oxides** and **Potash** are in excess. Hence, laterites are not suitable for cultivation. However, the application of manures and fertilizers is required to make the soils fertile for cultivation.

*They are well **developed in parts of Western Ghats, Eastern Ghats**, South Maharashtra, parts of Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Odisha, West Bengal, Kerala, Jharkhand, Meghalaya, and Assam. Laterite soil is widely spread in India and covers an area of 2.48 lakh sq. km. It is **mostly found in Kerala (Malabar Coastal region)** followed by Maharashtra. In laterite soil a common relationship is found between height and chemical composition. The **upper parts are more acidic than the inner ones.**

1. Which of the following statements regarding laterite soils of India are correct ?

1. They are generally red in colour
 2. They are rich in nitrogen and potash.
 3. They are well-developed in Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh.
 4. Tapioca and cashew nuts grow well on these soils.
- Select the correct answer using the codes given below

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2, 3 and 4
(c) 1 and 4 (d) 2 and 3 only

I.A.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

The Laterite soil is red in colour due to the wide diffusion of Iron and Aluminium oxides through the materials of the soil. Generally, Laterite soil is deficient in nitrogen, lime, and humus, but rich in Iron & Aluminium. Laterite soil is mostly found in South Maharashtra, parts of Karnataka, Kerala, and Meghalaya. Typical Laterite soils generally lack fertility and are of little use for crop production. Tapioca and Cashew nuts grow well on these soils.

2. Which of the following statements is true regarding Laterite soil in India?

1. Laterite soil develops in areas with high temperature and heavy rainfall.
2. Laterite soil is rich in humus and found in West Bengal, Assam and Odisha.

- (a) Only 2 is true
(b) Both 1 and 2 are true
(c) Both 1 and 2 are false
(d) Only 1 is true

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

Laterite soils are typical soils of tropical climates with monsoon like seasonal rainfall. Laterite soil develops in areas with high temperature and heavy rainfall. The fertility of Laterite soil is low... because of lesser contents of Humus, Nitrogen and Phosphorus.

3. Which of the following statements is correct about laterite soil?

- (1) This soil is developed in areas with high temperature and heavy rainfall.
- (2) It is poor in iron oxide and aluminium.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

Code :

- (a) Neither 1 nor 2 (b) Both 1 and 2

(c) Only 1

(d) Only 2

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

Laterite has been derived from the Latin word 'Later' which means brick. The laterite soils develop in areas with high temperature and high rainfall. Hence statement (1) is correct. With rain, lime and silica are leached away, and soils rich in iron oxide and aluminium compounds are left behind. Hence statement (2) is incorrect. Thus, option (c) is the correct answer.

4. Which of the following statements is not true, with respect to 'Laterite soils' in India?

- (a) They are deficient in lime and nitrogen.
(b) They provide good building materials.
(c) They are affected by leaching process.
(d) They are moisture retentive with large clay factor.

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (d)

Laterite soil is a type of soil that forms in tropical and subtropical regions as a result of the weathering of rocks rich in Iron and Aluminium. This soil is red to reddish yellow in colour. Heavy rains cause leaching of bases and silica from the surface of the soil. The soil shows acidic character and is poor in Nitrogen, Phosphorus, Potash, Magnesium and Lime. Such soil is porous and well-drained with poor water-holding capacity.

5. Assertion (A) : The percentage of net sown area in the total area of Andhra Pradesh is less as compared to that of West Bengal.

Reason (R) : The soil of most of Andhra Pradesh is laterite.

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are individually true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are individually true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) 'A' is true, but 'R' is false.
(d) 'A' is false, but 'R' is true.

I.A.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (c)